STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE			P-4410	
	SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA **GREG LONDON** **SHERIFF**	DATE ISSUED 06/01/06	DATE REVISED **03/06/23**	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
		APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		
CHAPTER TITLE ROAD PATROL	RESOURCES			
SUBJECT SUSPICIOUS PACKAGES/BIOLOGICAL THREATS	CROSS REFERENCE			

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to establish procedures for handling suspicious packages that may contain dangerous biological materials including anthrax.

II. Policy:

Many facilities and private citizens have received alleged packages and letters containing anthrax or similar hazardous material. The Sarpy County Sheriff's Office shall follow specific procedures to safeguard the public and the members of the department.

III. Procedures:

A. Unopened Suspicious Packages-Deputy Responsibilities: Deputies shall respond to all citizen calls of suspicious unopened packages and letters.

1. The responding deputy shall visually inspect the package or letter to determine if it meets the requirements for a suspicious package (see section D).

2. If the package or letter does not meet the requirements for a suspicious package, the deputy shall advise the citizen that he or she may open the package or dispose of it. It shall be the citizen's choice.

3. If the deputy believes the package is suspicious:

a) The deputy shall wear latex gloves and a surgical mask prior to touching the package or letter.

b) If possible, the package or letter shall be placed in **(2)** zip lock evidence bags and each bag shall be sealed.

c) After the item has been secured, the deputy shall remove the surgical mask and latex gloves and place these items in **(2)** additional zip lock evidence bags. Each bag shall be sealed.

d) The deputy shall notify his or her shift supervisor.

e) The deputy shall complete an incident report.

B. Opened Suspicious Packages-Deputy Responsibilities: If a package or letter is opened and meets the requirements for a suspicious package, the responding deputy shall:

1. Request the air handling system (HVAC system) for the building be turned off.

2. Evacuate the building.

3. Secure the entrance and allow only appropriate emergency personnel inside the residence.

4. Determine who has had contact with the package.

5. Keep exposed individuals in an isolated location.

6. Request the appropriate Haz-Mat Team respond.

7. Notify the shift supervisor.

8. Complete an incident report.

C. Suspicious Packages-Supervisor Responsibilities:

1. The shift supervisor shall respond to all locations where a suspicious package or letter is discovered.

2. The shift supervisor shall notify the on-duty watch commander or the ADC.

3. The shift supervisor shall request an agent from the Omaha FBI office respond to the scene.

4. The suspicious package or letter (and the exposed gloves and surgical mask) shall be turned over to the FBI.

5. The shift supervisor should consider setting up a Field Command Post (G-10410) to coordinate response with additional resources.

D. Requirements for a Suspicious Package: Deputies shall use the following characteristics when determining if a package or letter is suspicious:

1. Excessive postage.
2. Handwritten or poorly typed addresses.
3. Incorrect titles.
4. Titles but no names.
5. Misspellings of common words.
6. Oily stains, discolorations or odors.
7. No return address.
8. Excessive weight.
9. Lopsided or uneven envelope.
10. Protruding wires or aluminum foil.
11. Excessive securing material such as tape or string.
12. Visual distractions.
13. Ticking sounds.
14. Marked with restrictive endorsements, such as “Personal” or “Confidential.”
15. Shows a city or state in the postmark that does not match the return address.
16. Package is leaking a powder.